



Missing the mark: Abhishek Sharma and Travis Head have been far from their marauding best this season.

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years, the ball got wet, and execution was a lot tougher,” he said.

Bowling fuller and straighter has also proven to be more effective this season. Deliveries in line of the stumps went at 10.60 runs an over at the death in 2024, while in 2025 that number has dropped to 9.29. Straighter deliveries have also become a better wicket-taking preposition, with their average dropping from 22.73 runs per wicket in 2024 to 15.79 in 2025.

In a tailspin

The death overs have also seen the resurgence of spinners in 2025. They have been more frequently employed in the last five overs this season, and their effectiveness has doubled. Their wickets tally in overs 16 to 20 has swelled from 21 in 2024 to 46 in 2025, and their ability to contain has also increased considerably, with their economy rate dropping from 10.96 to 8.89 during this phase of the innings.

The spinners have made their presence felt particularly in the 16th over, when the batters are setting the launchpad for a death-overs charge. At this critical juncture, the spinners have picked 18 wickets this

Phase-wise comparison of run rates (IPL 2024 vs 2025)

■ PowerPlay ■ Middle Overs ■ Death Overs

